

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY

CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761 → DECLINE AS A CONVERGING → SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID → FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS → THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP → THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761

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AURANGZEB DIES; CONTESTED SUCCESSION OPENS THE CORE PERIOD

JAHANDAR FALLS; FARRUKHSIYAR RISES WITH SAYYID SUPPORT

FARRUKHSIYAR DEPOSED; REPEATED ENTHRONEMENTS EXPOSE KINGMAKING

SAYYIDS FALL

NIZAM ESTABLISHES DECCAN AUTONOMY

NADIR SHAH DEFEATS THE MUGHALS AND SACKS DELHI

ABDALI INVASIONS

1707 → Aurangzeb dies; contested succession opens the core period

1712-13 → Jahandar falls; Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support

1719 → Farrukhsiyar deposed; repeated entronements expose kingmaking

1720 → Sayyids fall

1724 → Nizam establishes Deccan autonomy

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1707 → Aurangzeb dies; contested succession opens the core period
- 1712-13 → Jahandar falls; Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support
- 1719 → Farrukhsiyar deposed; repeated entronements expose kingmaking

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1720 → Sayyids fall
- 1724 → Nizam establishes Deccan autonomy
- 1739 → Nadir Shah defeats the Mughals and sacks Delhi

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1748-61 → Abdali invasions
- 14 Jan 1761 → Third Battle of Panipat.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1748-61 → Abdali invasions | 14 Jan 1761 → Third Battle of Panipat.

01

STAGE 01

DECLINE AS A CONVERGING SYSTEM

DECLINE AS A CONVERGING SYSTEM

SUCCESSION CONFLICT + WIZARAT COMPETITION + NOBLE FACTIONS

JAGIR SCARCITY + JAMA-HASIL GAP + SHORT-TERM EXTRACTION

ZAMINDAR RESISTANCE, PEASANT FLIGHT AND UNEVEN COLLECTION

DECCAN EXHAUSTION, WEAK CONTINGENTS AND FRONTIER SHOCKS

PROVINCIAL GOVERNORS CONVERT OFFICE INTO DURABLE AUTONOMY

NO STRAND ALONE EXPLAINS TIMING, REACH OR CONTINUITY.

POLITICAL → succession conflict + wizarat competition + noble factions

FISCAL → jagir scarcity + jama-hasil gap + short-term extraction

AGRARIAN → zamindar resistance, peasant flight and uneven collection

MILITARY → Deccan exhaustion, weak contingents and frontier shocks

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- POLITICAL → succession conflict + wizarat competition + noble factions
- FISCAL → jagir scarcity + jama-hasil gap + short-term extraction

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- AGRARIAN → zamindar resistance, peasant flight and uneven collection
- MILITARY → Deccan exhaustion, weak contingents and frontier shocks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- REGIONAL → provincial governors convert office into durable autonomy
- RULE → no strand alone explains timing, reach or continuity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → no strand alone explains timing, reach or continuity.

02

STAGE 02

SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID WIZARAT

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BAHADUR SHAH I

WINS THE 1707 SUCCESSION BUT SETTLES NO FIRM RULE

JAHANDAR SHAH

ZULFIQAR KHAN'S PATRONAGE SHOWS WAZIR-CENTRED LEVERAGE

FARRUKHSIYAR 1713

THRONE SECURED THROUGH THE SAYYID BROTHERS

THE SAME COALITION DEPOSES AND KILLS HIM

BAHADUR SHAH I → wins the 1707 succession but settles no firm rule

JAHANDAR SHAH → Zulfiqar Khan's patronage shows wazir-centred leverage

FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → throne secured through the Sayyid Brothers

1719 → the same coalition deposes and kills him

ABDULLAH / HUSSAIN ALI → office, army and patronage sustain kingmaking

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- BAHADUR SHAH I → wins the 1707 succession but settles no firm rule
- JAHANDAR SHAH → Zulfiqar Khan's patronage shows wazir-centred leverage

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → throne secured through the Sayyid Brothers
- 1719 → the same coalition deposes and kills him

IMPACT / LIMIT

- ABDULLAH / HUSSAIN ALI → office, army and patronage sustain kingmaking
- 1720 → rival nobles remove them; factional rule outlives the episode.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1720 → rival nobles remove them; factional rule outlives the episode.

03

STAGE 03

FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS

FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS

ASSESSED OR ESTIMATED REVENUE CLAIM ON PAPER

REVENUE ACTUALLY REALISED AFTER CONTROL, HARVEST AND COLLECTION

RESERVE POOL AVAILABLE FOR ASSIGNMENT

SHORTAGE OF SUFFICIENTLY PRODUCTIVE AND USABLE JAGIRS

A HIGH JAMA CAN CONCEAL A WEAK HASIL

03

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- BAHADUR SHAH I → wins the 1707 succession but settles no firm rule
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MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

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04

STAGE 03

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RESERVE POOL AVAILABLE FOR ASSIGNMENT

SHORTAGE OF SUFFICIENTLY PRODUCTIVE AND USABLE JAGIRS

A HIGH JAMA CAN CONCEAL A WEAK HASIL

JAGIR IS A TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT, NOT PRIVATE OWNERSHIP.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
JAMA → assessed or estimated revenue claim on paper	PAIBAQI → reserve pool available for assignment	MEASUREMENT → a high jama can conceal a weak hasil
HASIL → revenue actually realised after control, harvest and collection	BE-JAGIRI → shortage of sufficiently productive and usable jagirs	TRAP → jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- JAMA → assessed or estimated revenue claim on paper
- HASIL → revenue actually realised after control, harvest and collection

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- PAIBAQI → reserve pool available for assignment
- BE-JAGIRI → shortage of sufficiently productive and usable jagirs

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MEASUREMENT → a high jama can conceal a weak hasil
- TRAP → jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership.

05

STAGE 04

THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP

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MORE CLAIMANTS

WEAK PAIBAQI

PRESSURE FOR PRODUCTIVE ASSIGNMENTS

SHORT TENURE

POOR JAGIR

ASSIGNEE SEEKS RAPID EXTRACTION

LOCAL PRESSURE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MORE CLAIMANTS / WEAK PAIBAQI → pressure for productive assignments
- SHORT TENURE / POOR JAGIR → assignee seeks rapid extraction

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LOCAL PRESSURE → zamindar resistance, evasion, debt, flight or negotiation
- LOWER HASIL → contingent maintenance and imperial service weaken

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MILITARY FAILURE / DISTURBANCE → collection becomes still harder
- RESULT → fiscal, agrarian and political strain reproduces itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → fiscal, agrarian and political strain reproduces itself.

06

STAGE 05

THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

1686-87 ANNEXATIONS

MORE TERRITORY, FORTS, ELITES AND PAPER REVENUE

1687-1707 WAR

SIEGE, TRANSPORT, GARRISON AND REMOUNT COSTS ACCUMULATE

BUFFER REMOVAL

DIRECT CONFLICT WITH DISPERSED MARATHA NETWORKS EXPANDS

DISTURBED DISTRICTS

1686-87 ANNEXATIONS → more territory, forts, elites and paper revenue

1687-1707 WAR → siege, transport, garrison and remount costs accumulate

BUFFER REMOVAL → direct conflict with dispersed Maratha networks expands

DISTURBED DISTRICTS → assessed jama outruns reliable hasil

POST-1707 INHERITANCE → claimant pressure and military obligations remain

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 1686-87 ANNEXATIONS → more territory, forts, elites and paper revenue
- 1687-1707 WAR → siege, transport, garrison and remount costs accumulate

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- BUFFER REMOVAL → direct conflict with dispersed Maratha networks expands
- DISTURBED DISTRICTS → assessed jama outruns reliable hasil

DEBATE / LEGACY

- POST-1707 INHERITANCE → claimant pressure and military obligations remain
- VERDICT → Deccan war is a legacy mechanism, not the whole decline story.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Deccan war is a legacy mechanism, not the whole decline story.

STAGE 06

FROM CENTRE TO REGION: A SPECTRUM

FROM CENTRE TO REGION

A SPECTRUM

DIRECT CENTRE

APPOINTMENT, REVENUE ORDER AND MILITARY COMMAND FROM DELHI

NEGOTIATED PROVINCE

GOVERNOR AND LOCAL ELITES BARGAIN WITHIN IMPERIAL FORMS

DE FACTO AUTONOMY

PROVINCIAL RULER CONTROLS REVENUE, ARMY AND SUCCESSION

DIRECT CENTRE → appointment, revenue order and military command from Delhi

NEGOTIATED PROVINCE → governor and local elites bargain within imperial forms

DE FACTO AUTONOMY → provincial ruler controls revenue, army and succession

FORMAL DEFERENCE → title, coin, khutba or confirmation may still invoke emperor

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DIRECT CENTRE → appointment, revenue order and military command from Delhi

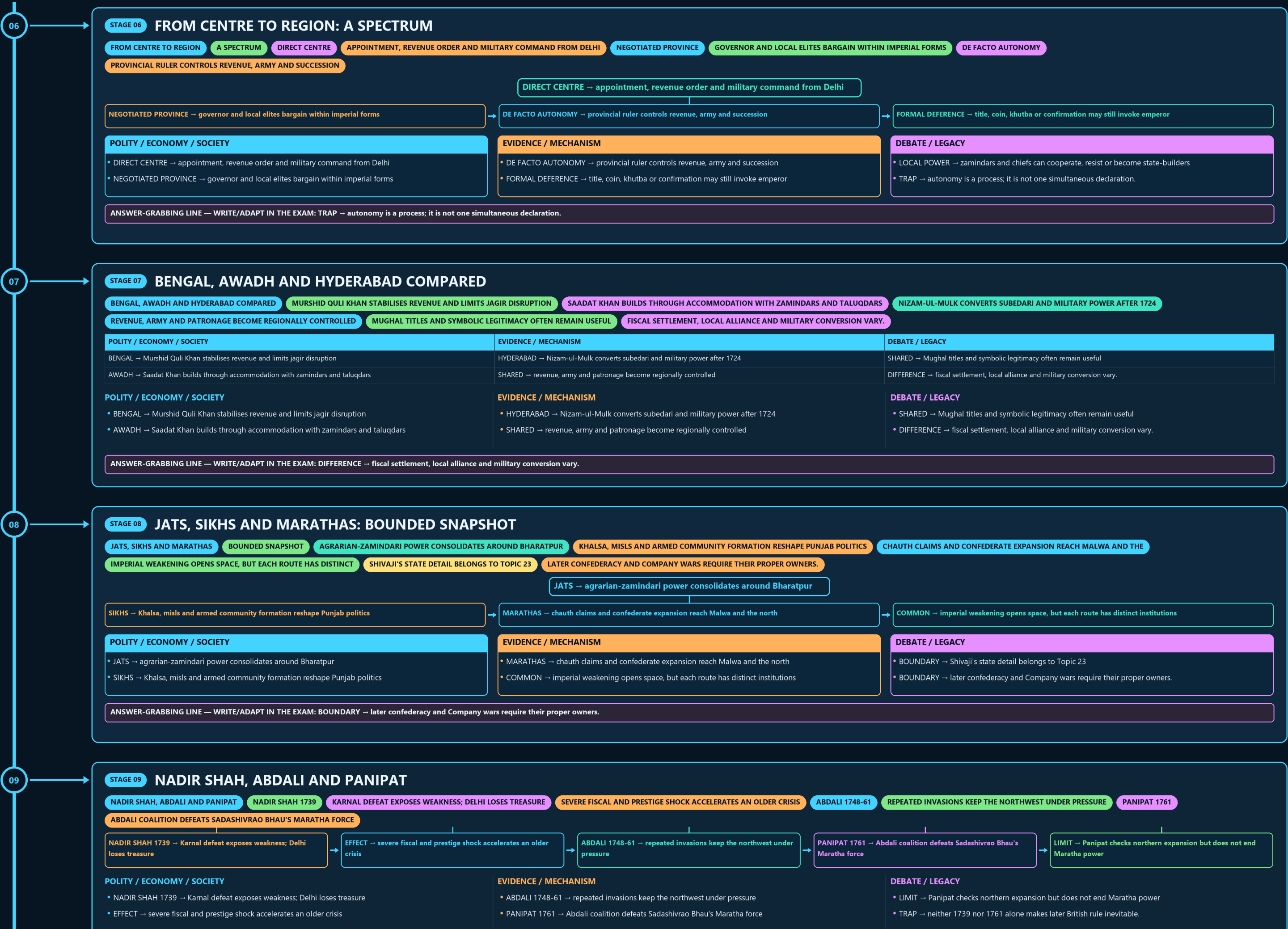
EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DE FACTO AUTONOMY → provincial ruler controls revenue, army and succession

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LOCAL POWER → zamindars and chiefs can cooperate, resist or become state-builders

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2630-5864 of 11124 • continues below



09

STAGE 09 NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT

NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT

NADIR SHAH 1739

KARNAL DEFEAT EXPOSES WEAKNESS; DELHI LOSES TREASURE

SEVERE FISCAL AND PRESTIGE SHOCK ACCELERATES AN OLDER CRISIS

ABDALI 1748-61

REPEATED INVASIONS KEEP THE NORTHWEST UNDER PRESSURE

PANIPAT 1761

ABDALI COALITION DEFEATS SADASHIVRAO BHAU'S MARATHA FORCE

NADIR SHAH 1739 → Karnal defeat exposes weakness; Delhi loses treasure

EFFECT → severe fiscal and prestige shock accelerates an older crisis

ABDALI 1748-61 → repeated invasions keep the northwest under pressure

PANIPAT 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Sadashivrao Bha'u's Maratha force

LIMIT → Panipat checks northern expansion but does not end Maratha power

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NADIR SHAH 1739 → Karnal defeat exposes weakness; Delhi loses treasure
- EFFECT → severe fiscal and prestige shock accelerates an older crisis

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- ABDALI 1748-61 → repeated invasions keep the northwest under pressure
- PANIPAT 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Sadashivrao Bha'u's Maratha force

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LIMIT → Panipat checks northern expansion but does not end Maratha power
- TRAP → neither 1739 nor 1761 alone makes later British rule inevitable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → neither 1739 nor 1761 alone makes later British rule inevitable.

10

STAGE 10 REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY

REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY

POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS

PATRONAGE AND RESOURCES SHIFT REGIONALLY

HOUSES SUCH AS JAGAT SETH REMAIN INFLUENTIAL

ROUTES AND PRODUCTION PERSIST UNEVENLY ACROSS REGIONS

COURTS SUPPORT ART, LITERATURE AND ARCHITECTURE

WARFARE, EXTRACTION AND LOCAL LOSSES REMAIN REAL

REGIONAL REORGANISATION, NOT UNIFORM ECONOMIC-CULTURAL COLLAPSE.

POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS → patronage and resources shift regionally

BANKERS / CREDIT → houses such as Jagat Seth remain influential

TRADE / CRAFT → routes and production persist unevenly across regions

AWADH / HYDERABAD / BENGAL → courts support art, literature and architecture

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS → patronage and resources shift regionally
- BANKERS / CREDIT → houses such as Jagat Seth remain influential

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- TRADE / CRAFT → routes and production persist unevenly across regions
- AWADH / HYDERABAD / BENGAL → courts support art, literature and architecture

DEBATE / LEGACY

- QUALIFY → warfare, extraction and local losses remain real
- VERDICT → regional reorganisation, not uniform economic-cultural collapse.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → regional reorganisation, not uniform economic-cultural collapse.

11

STAGE 11 NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE

NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE

DECLINE IS DEVOLUTION AND CONVERGING STRAIN, NOT INSTANT DISAPPEARANCE

JAGIRDARI LOOP

REGIONAL AUTONOMY

EXTERNAL SHOCKS

HYDERABAD BY DISTINCT MECHANISM

POLITICAL FRAGMENTATION WITH ECONOMIC-CULTURAL CONTINUITY

RULER-ONLY BLAME, ONE-CAUSE CRISIS AND AUTOMATIC COLONIAL SUCCESSION

OPEN → decline is devolution and converging strain, not instant disappearance

TRACE → succession → jagirdari loop → regional autonomy → external shocks

COMPARE → Bengal / Awadh / Hyderabad by distinct mechanism

BALANCE → political fragmentation with economic-cultural continuity

REJECT → ruler-only blame, one-cause crisis and automatic colonial succession

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → decline is devolution and converging strain, not instant disappearance
- TRACE → succession → jagirdari loop → regional autonomy → external shocks

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COMPARE → Bengal / Awadh / Hyderabad by distinct mechanism
- BALANCE → political fragmentation with economic-cultural continuity

DEBATE / LEGACY

- REJECT → ruler-only blame, one-cause crisis and automatic colonial succession
- CLOSE → 1707-61 created opportunities; later outcomes remained contingent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → 1707-61 created opportunities; later outcomes remained contingent.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK

TWENTY-FOUR SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS

EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-four source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- Decline of the Mughal Empire & the Eighteenth Century — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Historiography ladder (PYQ-gap)

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.